

Open Source Office Suites Can Replace Microsoft Office

An office suite is designed to make things easy. It is a bundle of software put together to facilitate the work of an organisation. Open source office suites like OpenOffice and LibreOffice have evolved considerably in recent years, and smaller businesses can benefit by using these free software in place of Microsoft Office.



MS Excel, presentation software comparable to Power Point, a database comparable to MS Access, and even drawing and math equation tools similar to those included in MS Office.

OpenOffice currently doesn't have all of the advanced features that MS Office offers. It can, in fact, read and write documents created with MS Office. This means that you can happily exchange documents with people who use MS Office.

The documents created by OpenOffice may look different when opened in MS Office. The programs are compatible with each other in that they can both read and write the same file formats, but in practice, they are not identical. Minor and occasionally major reformatting is required while exchanging documents between the two. If this minor inconvenience matters, OpenOffice may not be the best choice for you. OpenOffice is available for Microsoft, Mac and Linux. It looks exactly the same no matter what platform you use. OpenOffice is completely free. Just download, install and use it.

LibreOffice is a separate version of OpenOffice. These two office assistants are still very similar and LibreOffice includes OpenOffice Basic. However, Apache OpenOffice may not be able to keep up with the speed of development in LibreOffice.

There are many reasons why LibreOffice can win. First of all, it has many more programmers working on

A single new office suite can change the way we think about office automation. Inventing it using AI, ML, etc, remains a challenging struggle for a creative programmer. Programmers belonging to the open source community are now using better code to reconstruct the decades-old king of the office – Microsoft Office. This has resulted in the birth of the following new open source office suites:

- Apache OpenOffice, which is a comprehensive suite for Windows, MacOS and Linux.
- Open Document Foundation's LibreOffice, which is a fork of Open Office for Windows, MacOS and Linux.
- NeoOffice, a Java based branch of OpenOffice for MacOS.
- Calligra, which runs on Windows, Linux, free Berkeley Software Distribution (BSD) and MacOS.

Closed and licence based office suites like Microsoft Office and Word Star have somehow ruled the enterprise and personal desktop for several decades.

Popular open source office suites: OpenOffice and LibreOffice

If you are thinking of purchasing MS Word, remember that it may cost you US\$ 100 or perhaps even less to purchase and install it on your computer. OpenOffice Writer works the same way as Word. Now more popularly known as Apache OpenOffice and very similar to LibreOffice, OpenOffice can be an effective alternative to MS Word and even some other familiar MS Office applications.

Apache OpenOffice is a completely free suite of programs. It includes a word processor comparable to MS Word, a spreadsheet comparable to